

Marketing Weekly Compendium (A4 Optimized)

Marketing Weekly Compendium

2023 — Full Summary

Prepared for: Tata Consumer Products PPI —

Technical Competence Round (MT Role)

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

Part 1 is a topic-by-topic summary of everything in the compendium (242 slides, ~30 topics).

Part 2 translates this into the questions you're actually likely to

get, given your profile:

2-month intern, India Sales division, Pharma sector, TCP —

territories: Vadodara, Ahmedabad, Surat.

Since Round 1 was about the MT role itself, Round 2

(Technical Competence) will test whether you understand the sales & distribution engine you worked inside, not just marketing theory.

PART 1: TOPIC-WISE SUMMARY

1. Fundamentals of Marketing

Marketing = meeting consumer demand profitably; a pull strategy — you create demand and prospects come to you.

Selling = convincing a prospect to buy; a push strategy — used when differentiation is hard (telecom, insurance).

Marketing vs Selling: Marketing is customer-centric/pull/long-term; Selling is product-centric/push/short-term.

2. Marketing Mix (4P / 7P)

Product: 3 levels — Core (intended benefit), Actual

(features, quality, branding, packaging), Augmented

(warranty, after-sales, credit, delivery).

Price: Promotional, Dynamic, Penetration, Psychological,

Economy, Premium, Freemium, Bundle pricing.

Place: Direct sales, indirect channels (one-

level/hybrid/multi-channel), e-commerce.

Promotion: Sales Promotion (discounts, BTL, bundles) vs

Marketing Promotion (campaigns, sponsorships).

7P (services) adds: People (staff delivering the service),

Process (steps to deliver service), Physical Evidence

(branding/environment — uniforms, service centers,

website).

Worked examples in the deck: iPhone 14 Pro Max,

Vaseline, McDonald's (7P).

3. Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning

(STP)

Segmentation: breaking a mass market into groups with

common needs — Geographic, Demographic,

Psychographic, Behavioural.

MSADA test for a good segment: Measurable, Substantial,

Accessible, Differentiable, Actionable.

Targeting: choosing which segments to serve (product

specialization vs market specialization).

Positioning: owning a distinct idea in the consumer's mind

(Volvo = Safety, ENO = 6-second relief).

POD (Points of Difference): unique, owned attributes.

POP (Points of Parity): shared attributes — Category

POPs (table stakes), Correlational POPs (side-effects

of a positive, e.g. "cheap = maybe low quality"),

Competitive POPs (neutralizing a rival's POD).

Examples used: Marriott's multi-brand segmentation, ITC

Hotels' 4-brand ladder

(ITC/Welcomhotel/Fortune/WelcomHeritage).

4. Product Mix

Product Line: variants of one product under one brand

(e.g., Oreo flavors).

Product Line Length: number of products in one line.

Product Line Width: number of parallel product lines.

Product Mix Width: sum of all lines across all categories

(e.g., HUL/Unilever's full portfolio).

SKU: Stock Keeping Unit — a specific pack size/variant

(Maggi 70g, 280g, 420g are 3 SKUs).

Worked examples: Xiaomi, ITC (Aashirvaad, Sunfeast,

Yippee, Bingo, Classmate, Engage...), Vaseline's full sub-range.

5. Advertising Types — ATL / BTL / TTL

ATL

BTL

TTL

Target

Mass/undifferentiated

Specific

segment

Mass +

focused

conversion

Media

TV, Radio, Print,

Billboards

Flyers,

door-to-

door,

events,

SMS

Digital/360°

combining

both

Response

measurement

Hard to measure

Easy

(direct)

Easier than

ATL

FMCG uses ATL heavily for brand recall; BTL is used for

footfall/conversion at colleges, societies, high-traffic

zones.

6. Sales & Distribution Management (core

for your role)

Flow: Factory → C&F; Agent (logistics) → Warehouse/Depot →

Stockist/Distributor (urban) or Super-Stockist (rural) →

Wholesaler → Retailer → Consumer, with parallel Modern

Trade and E-commerce routes.

Three sale types (critical distinction — expect this question):

Primary Sales: Company → Distributor/Stockist.

Secondary Sales: Distributor/Stockist → Retailer/Dealer.

Tertiary Sales: Retailer/Dealer → Consumer (what actually reflects real market demand — MTs are usually judged on driving secondary/tertiary, not just primary billing).

Key roles:

C&F; Agent: transport/logistics partner; charges by distance, speed, and special handling (e.g., cold chain — relevant for pharma).

Stockist/Distributor (urban): services retailers directly; also sells bulk to wholesalers.

Super-Stockist (rural): bulk-supplies rural wholesalers; extends reach to deep rural markets; gets extra freight incentives.

Wholesaler: multi-brand, serves small/remote outlets; companies often try to reduce dependence on wholesalers as they erode price control.

Modern Trade (DMart, Big Bazaar): supplied directly, cutting distributor margin, letting MT pass savings to consumers as discounts.

Margin concept: every channel member earns a cut — e.g., a ₹5 chocolate bar might split ~1% C&F; ~2% distributor, ~5% retailer.

7. Planogram (Shelf Science)

Product sequencing: shoppers scan left-to-right; hero

SKUs placed left.

Belt-to-eye level: eye level = "buying level" for high-

margin/new items; kids' items (candy, toys) at belt-to-eye level of a child.

Vertical planogram: different brands stacked by shelf level, big packs low/small packs high.

Horizontal planogram: same category, different brands, same eye-level — enables comparison shopping.

Candy near the checkout counter = classic impulse-buy placement.

8. Strategic Frameworks

SWOT

X-axis: Helpful vs Harmful; Y-axis: Internal (S,W) vs

External (O,T) — a commonly missed nuance.

Worked examples: HUL-type FMCG SWOT (deep rural distribution as strength; D2C brands like Beardo/mCaffeine and private labels as threats) and Vaseline's SWOT.

BCG Matrix (Growth-Share Matrix)

Axes: Relative Market Share (x) vs Market Growth Rate (y).

Stars (high share, high growth) — invest; Cash Cows (high share, low growth) — harvest/fund the rest; Question

Marks (low share, high growth) — invest selectively or divest; Dogs (low share, low growth) — divest or revamp.

Limitation: only 2 dimensions; ignores inter-portfolio dependencies (a "Dog" might feed raw material to a "Star").

Worked examples: Tata Group portfolio (TCS/Titan=Stars, Tata Steel=Cash Cow, Tata Comm=Dog), Amul, Amazon.

Ansoff Matrix (Product-Market Matrix)

Market Penetration (existing product, existing market) — lowest risk, e.g. Buy-Now-Pay-Later to cut purchase

friction.

Product Development (new product, existing market) —

e.g. Britannia's Potatоз.

Market Development (existing product, new market) — e.g.

OYO in China, Zomato in UAE.

Diversification (new product, new market) — highest risk;

Related (Adani into green energy) vs Unrelated (Bajaj into finance via Bajaj Finserv).

9. Pricing Strategies (9 types)

Premium (Ferrari), Penetration (aviation), Predatory (telecom price wars — can be anti-competitive/illegal), Geographical (fuel, alcohol — driven by taxes/PPP), Price Skimming (new smartphones), Psychological (■199 vs ■200), Dynamic (airlines/cabs), Captive Product (razor cheap, blades priced high), Bundle (multi-product packs).

10. B2B vs B2C

B2C

B2B

Ticket size

Small

Large

Driver

Promotion/emotion

Efficiency/cost

Relationship

Short-term

Long-term

Decision

Simple, single

decision-maker

Multi-level,

committee-based

Digital Marketing/Purchase Funnel (10 stages): Engagement

→ Education → Research → Evaluation → Justification →

Purchase → Adoption → Retention → Expansion → Advocacy.

11. Product Life Cycle (PLC)

Stages: R&D; → Introduction → Growth → Maturity →

Decline.

PLC Extension tactics: facelifts (Hyundai Creta vs Kia

Seltos), flanker brands (Tata Tiago → Altroz to fight

Baleno), software suite expansion (MS Office).

12. Brand Fundamentals

Brand = the perception/emotional bond a customer has

with a product; a trademark is the legally protected

name/mark.

Brand Experience (sum of all touchpoints) vs Brand Image

(the mental construct in the customer's head).

Brand Value (financial worth, based on discounted future

cash flows) vs Brand Equity (customer

attitude/willingness to pay more) — a classic "explain the difference" interview question.

Brand Value Chain: Marketing investment → Customer

mindset (awareness, attitude) → Market performance

(price premium, elasticity) → Shareholder value.

Brand Rivalry

Exists to win new customers, win rival's customers, or win a larger share of shared/multi-homing customers.

Examples: Visa vs Mastercard, Coke vs Pepsi, McDonald's vs Burger King.

Benefits: builds loyalty, sympathy for smaller brands, free attention. Risks: can boost the rival's own visibility ("awakening a sleeping brand").

Brand Personality / 12 Archetypes

Framework: brands adopt human-like personality archetypes (Explorer, Innocent, Sage, Rebel, etc.) so customers form an emotional connection — 80% of purchase decisions are said to be made before conscious rational thought.

Brand Identity Prism (Kapferer, 1996)

Six facets: Physique (physical/visual cues), Personality (tone of voice), Culture (values), Relationship (brand-customer bond), Reflection (stereotypical user), Self-Image (how the customer sees their ideal self).

Brand Cannibalization

New product eats into an existing product's sales without growing total market share.

"If you don't cannibalize yourself, someone else will" —

Apple's yearly iPhone launches, Coca-Cola's flavor extensions (later ring-fenced by re-branding original as "Classic Coke"), Starbucks over-expansion cannibalizing its own premium positioning.

13. Consumer Psychology & Behavioural

Marketing

Classical Conditioning: pairing a neutral stimulus with an

existing response (Coca-Cola's "Thanda Matlab Coca-Cola"

linked existing "Thanda" positivity to the brand).

Operant Conditioning: reinforcement/punishment shapes

repeat behaviour (Starbucks Rewards = positive

reinforcement; Fair & Lovely-type ads = negative

reinforcement, i.e., relieving an implied "problem").

AIDA Model (Attention → Interest → Desire → Action):

classic linear funnel of a purchase decision; criticized for

ignoring post-purchase behaviour.

Framing Effect: how information is presented changes

decisions — Gain frame, Loss/FOMO frame, Statistics

frame, Emotion frame ("30% less sugar" framing).

Psychology of Selling: buyers respond to speed of

response (call within 5 minutes of an inquiry), respecting

their time, persistence (50% of sales close only after the

5th follow-up attempt), solving problems (not excuse-

making), and avoiding choice overload.

Goldilocks Effect: buyers gravitate to the mid-priced "just

right" option among three choices (classic 3-tier pricing

psychology used by Dollar Shave Club).

14. "Interesting Concepts" Cluster

Co-branding: two brands partnering for mutual value (Lay's

x Cadbury/KFC/Zomato/Spotify "HeartWork" campaign);

risk = cross-contamination if partner brand gets into

controversy.

Surrogate Marketing: since India (ASCI) bans direct

liquor/tobacco ads, brands promote via a "communicating

product" (Bagpiper Soda for Bagpiper Whiskey), proxy

commercials, movie placements, or sponsorships.

Guerrilla Marketing: low-cost, high-creativity, unconventional campaigns designed to surprise (outdoor, indoor, experiential/viral types).

Meme Marketing: leveraging shareable cultural content, especially to reach ad-averse Gen Z (Heinz's fruit-vs-vegetable meme, Zomato meme-jacking trends).

Emotional Marketing: uses core emotions — happiness, sorrow, anger, fear — to drive engagement and recall (P&G; "Like a Girl", WWF sorrow-based campaigns).

Cause Marketing: businesses tie sales/actions to a social cause — forms include Portion-of-Purchase, Transactional Campaigns, Point-of-Sale asks, Buy-One-Give-One. Notable FMCG-relevant examples: Tata Tea "Jaago Re" (moved TCP's tea business from #2 to #1 market share), Lifebuoy "Gondappa" (handwashing behaviour change, reduced diarrhoea incidence 36%→5%), Horlicks "Ahaar Abhiyan" (14% sales lift in West Bengal).

15. Rural Marketing (highly relevant to your

GT/pharma territories)

Rural ≠ scaled-down urban — requires a fresh strategy ("unlearn urban rules").

4 A's framework: Availability (deep distribution trade-off),

Awareness (traditional ATL — TV/radio), Acceptability (adapting the product to local usage), Affordability (small/low-unit-price SKUs, credit/loans).

Mix tweaks: smaller SKUs (CavinKare's 50-paisa Chik shampoo sachets, Coke's ■5 SKU), rural-specific

distribution (haats, melas, hub-and-spoke, self-help groups, van/mobile trade, ITC e-Choupal), rural-specific promotion (wall paintings, folk theatre, mobile publicity vans, opinion-leader endorsement).

16. Service Marketing

Marketing for intangible offerings; centers on the Service

Marketing Triangle (Company—Employees—Consumer).

4 service types by tangibility/target: People Processing

(salon), Possession Processing (packers & movers),

Mental Stimulus Processing (education/training),

Information Processing (IT/SAP-type services).

Example: Urban Company's Salon-at-Home.

17. Digital Marketing & Ecommerce

7 channels: Email/SMS/Push, SEM, SEO, Display, Social

Media, Content Marketing, Affiliate Marketing.

5 principles: find where prospects are, measure & optimize

continuously, and personalize

(demographic/geographic/behavioral/user-level).

Closed-Loop Marketing: tracking a lead across the full

funnel (visitor → lead → customer) via cookies/CRM to

connect marketing spend to actual sales outcomes.

E-commerce models: B2C, B2B, C2C, C2B (reverse model

— e.g., iStockPhoto), B2A/C2A (with

government/administration).

18. Startups / India Startup Ecosystem

Definition, funding stages (personal, angel, seed), and why

India's unicorn ecosystem is now globally significant

(compared with US/China) — largely context/general-knowledge material, lower priority for your interview.

PART 2: LIKELY INTERVIEW

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR PPI

(TECHNICAL COMPETENCE — MT ROLE)

Round 1 was about the MT role itself; Round 2 tests whether you can think and speak like a Sales MT — connect this theory to what you actually saw on the ground in Vadodara, Ahmedabad, and Surat. Expect a mix of (A) technical/conceptual, (B) internship-specific, and (C) situational/case questions.

A. Core S&D; concepts they will almost certainly probe

1. Walk me through the flow of a product from TCP's factory

to the final consumer. Where does the pharma channel differ from general trade?

2. What is the difference between Primary, Secondary, and

Tertiary sales? Why do sales managers focus more on secondary/tertiary than primary?

3. What is a C&F; agent's role? A stockist's? A super-

stockist's? (Be ready to distinguish urban stockist vs rural super-stockist.)

4. How does margin distribution work across the channel —

and what happens when a retailer/stockist feels the margin is too thin?

5. What's the difference between General Trade, Modern

Trade, and E-commerce as channels, and how does

TCP/Tata approach each?

6. Explain planogramming — why does shelf placement

matter, and what did you observe in pharmacies/chemist

outlets on your beat?

B. Questions that will directly reference your

internship

7. Why does a pharma-sector sales channel look different

from a typical FMCG (kirana) channel? (Think: prescription

influence, chemist relationships, stockist licensing/drug

laws, cold-chain/expiry sensitivity, lower footfall but higher

basket value per SKU.)

8. What specific challenges did you face covering Vadodara,

Ahmedabad, and Surat — market maturity differences,

competitive intensity, retailer relationships?

9. Give an example of a distributor/retailer issue you resolved

or observed being resolved.

10. What did a typical "market working" day look like for you?

(They want to hear beat plan, outlet coverage, order

booking, scheme communication, competitor tracking.)

11. What KPI would you use to judge whether your territory's

secondary sales were healthy, beyond just the primary

billing number?

C. Framework application — expect them to ask you to

apply a model to TCP, not just define it

12. Do a quick SWOT of TCP's presence in the market you

worked in.

13. Where would you place TCP's various brands (Tata Salt,

Tata Tea/Tetley, Sampann, Tata Sampann, Tata Coffee,
etc.) on a BCG matrix?

14. If TCP wanted to grow in your Pharma-adjacent territory,
which Ansoff strategy

(penetration/development/diversification) would you
recommend, and why?

15. Apply the 4 A's of rural marketing to a smaller town near
Surat/Vadodara/Ahmedabad you may have visited.

D. Situational / case-style (common in Technical
Competence rounds for MT roles)

16. A key stockist threatens to stop stocking your brand
because a competitor is offering a better margin. What do
you do?

17. Sales in one outlet cluster are flat despite good distribution
(numeric availability). What could be going wrong, and how
would you diagnose it? (Point to planogram/visibility,
pricing vs competition, scheme awareness, stock-outs on
hero SKUs.)

18. You're asked to launch a new SKU designed for price-
sensitive, high-footfall outlets. Walk through your go-to-
market thinking using the 4Ps.

E. Behavioral / "why MT" wrap-up questions

19. What did this internship teach you about the gap between
marketing theory and on-ground sales execution?

20. Why do you want to be a Management Trainee, and how
does your Pharma/India Sales internship prepare you for
the rotational, generalist nature of an MT program?

21. What would you do differently if given the same territory

again?

Quick-reference "if they ask you to define X

in one line" cheat sheet

Marketing vs Selling → Pull vs Push.

Primary/Secondary/Tertiary sales →

Company→Distributor / Distributor→Retailer /

Retailer→Consumer.

BCG → Share × Growth → Star/Cash Cow/Question

Mark/Dog.

Ansoff → Product × Market →

Penetration/Development/Development/Diversification.

STP → Segment → Target → Position; test segments with

MSADA.

POP vs POD → Shared attribute vs unique/owned

attribute.

Brand Equity vs Brand Value → Customer

attitude/willingness to pay vs financial/monetary worth of

the brand.

AIDA → Attention → Interest → Desire → Action.

4 A's (Rural) → Availability, Awareness, Acceptability,

Affordability.

Tip for the round: whenever a concept comes up, anchor your

answer with a concrete example from

Vadodara/Ahmedabad/Surat rather than a textbook FMCG

example — that's what will differentiate you from other

candidates who've only read the theory.